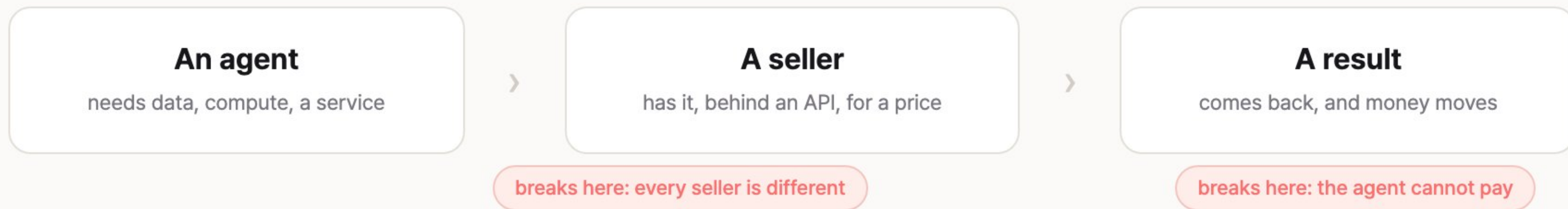


x402, the Agent Capability Market, and **h402**.

YoungHwi Cho (Project7) | Co-founder at HUNT



Agent commerce is an agent buying something on its own, and today the purchase breaks in two places.



A human buyer signs up, learns the product, and pays. An agent can do the middle part. The first and last parts still need a person, and that is the whole gap this talk is about.

The gap splits into two problems: learning every seller, and paying each one.

problem one

Does the agent have to learn every seller?

Every API has its own docs, SDK, request shape and error style. Teaching an agent all of them, one at a time, does not scale.

worked on for a decade, mostly solved

problem two

How does the agent actually pay?

An agent cannot open an account, accept terms, or clear a captcha. Until this year there was no answer that did not route through a person.

new, and moving fast

Giving one agent four real APIs by hand means four accounts, four keys, four SDKs and four test cycles.

Nansen

smart money flows

- request API access
- pick a paid tier
- store the key
- learn their schema
- handle rate limits
- test, then retest

from \$99 / month

Exa

web search

- create an account
- add a card
- store the key
- install the SDK
- map the response
- test, then retest

usage billed monthly

Google Maps

place details

- GCP project + billing
- enable the API
- restrict the key
- learn the field masks
- watch the quota
- test, then retest

billing account required

ElevenLabs

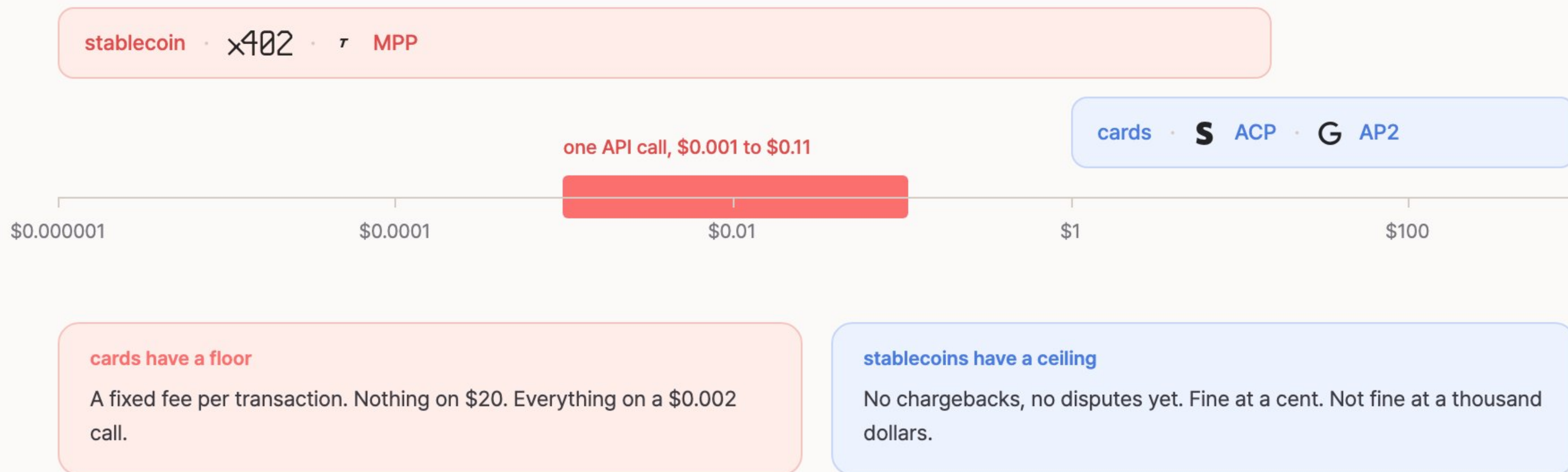
text to speech

- sign up
- choose a plan
- store the key
- pick a voice id
- handle audio streams
- test, then retest

character quota per plan

Four vendors, four billing relationships, four request shapes. And a human in every one of the first three steps.

Card rails stop working below about a dollar. Stablecoin rails do not, and that is where an API call lives.



x402 puts the price in an HTTP 402 response and lets the client pay inside the retry.

```
$ GET /routes/nansen/crypto/smart-money-flows
HTTP/1.1 402 Payment Required { "amount": "52500", "asset": "USDC", "network": "eip155:8453" }
$ GET /routes/nansen/crypto/smart-money-flows X-PAYMENT: <signed EIP-3009 authorization>
HTTP/1.1 200 OK { "data": [ ... ] }
```

1

Ask

The seller answers 402 with the exact price.

2

Sign

The agent signs an EIP-3009 authorization offchain. No gas.

3

Settle

A facilitator verifies it and moves the USDC onchain.

4

Deliver

The result comes back with a payment reference.

1997 402 reserved in HTTP, unused

2025 Coinbase publishes x402

Apr 2026 moved to the Linux Foundation

~165M calls, about \$50M, by late April

Four standards, split by job: two for machines buying from machines, two for agents buying from shops.

machines buying from machines · APIs, compute, data

Per call, fractions of a cent

x402

x402

Coinbase → Linux Foundation

τ

MPP

Stripe + Tempo

agents buying from shops · goods, checkouts, plans

Dollars, a cardholder behind it

S

ACP

Stripe + OpenAI

G

AP2

Google

S **Stripe built one for each camp, then bridged them.**
In MPP a seller answers one 402 and accepts either a stablecoin or a card. The card leg is a Shared Payment Token.

shared payment token					≈	eip-3009 authorization				
for	one seller · up to	one amount · until	expiry ·			for	one address · up to	one amount · until	validBefore ·	
kept by	Stripe					kept by	the agent			



**A capability market for agents.
Mount it once, call any listed
API, **pay per call.****

```
/routes/{provider}/{category}/{action}
```



The same four APIs on h402: one call path each, no accounts, and the price shown before the call.

by hand, per vendor

Nansen account · tier · key · schema · limits · tests

Exa account · card · key · SDK · mapping · tests

Google Maps GCP · billing · key · masks · quota · tests

ElevenLabs account · plan · key · voice · streams · tests

on h402, one line each

/routes/nansen/crypto/smart-money-flows \$0.05

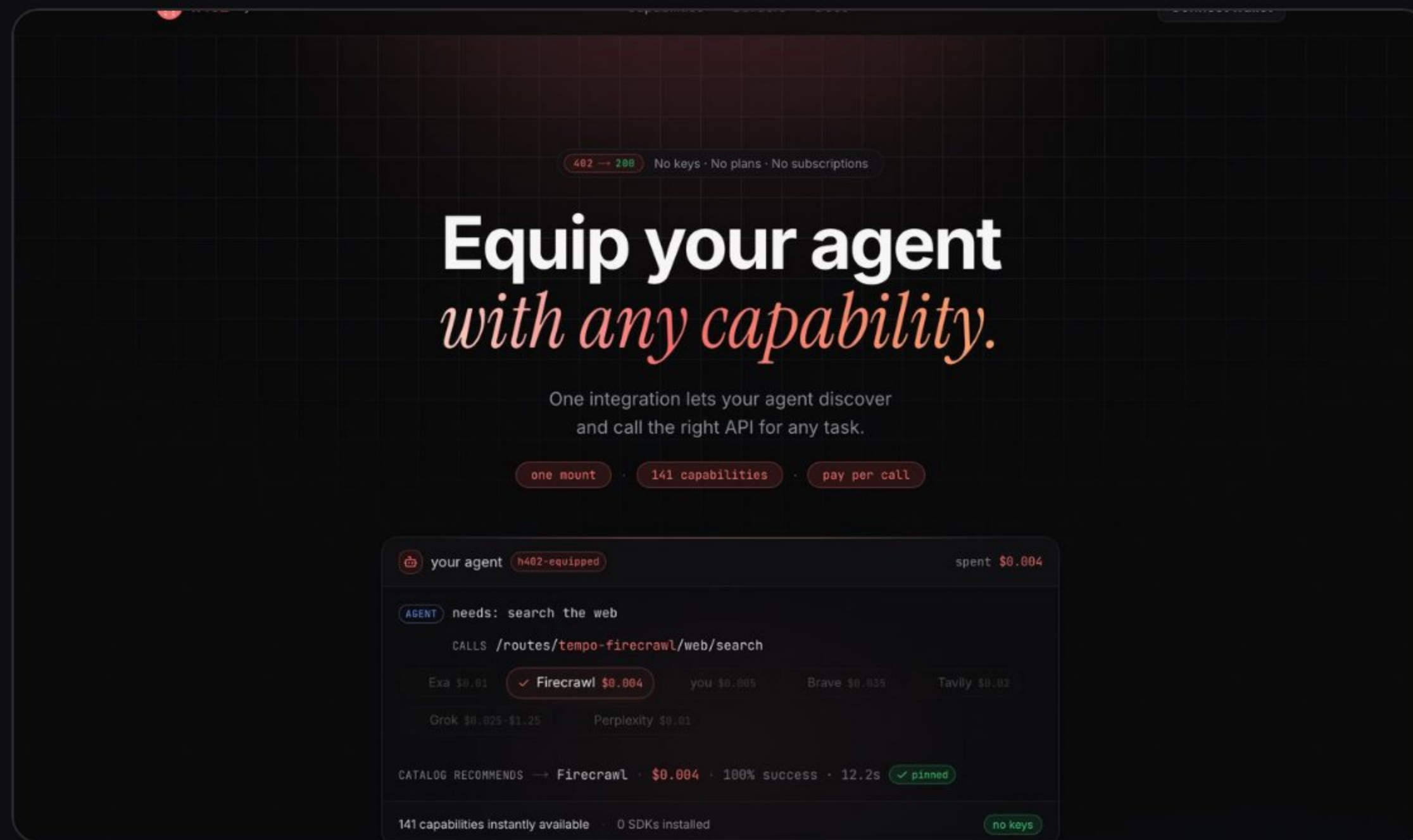
/routes/stableenrich-exa/web/search \$0.004

/routes/stableenrich-googlemaps/maps/place-details \$0.02

/routes/blockrun-elevenlabs/ai/text-to-speech from \$0.001

Four vendors became four lines. The agent never met any of them. Prices are live quotes and move.

What is live today: 141 capabilities, 71 provider contracts, every enabled route paid-tested.



141

capabilities

across 16 categories

71

provider contracts

competing on shared task paths

100%

paid-tested

every enabled route, with real calls

Base

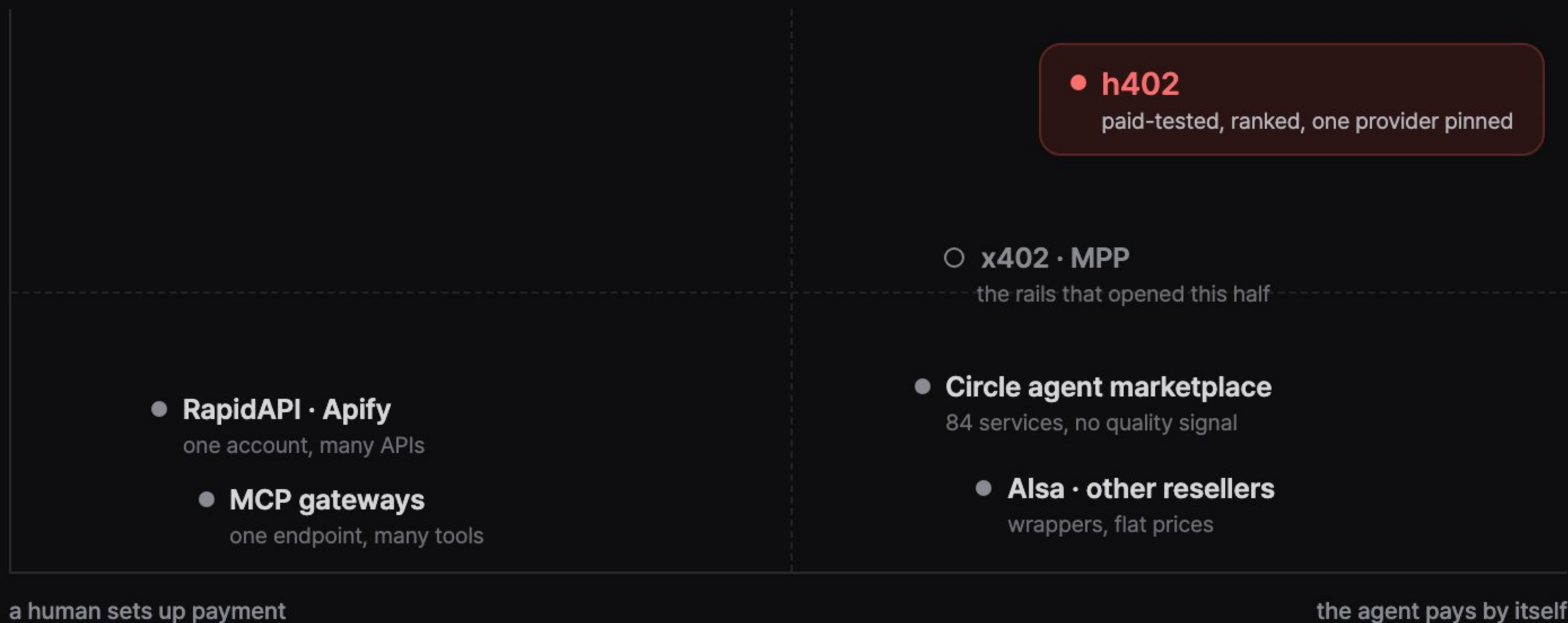
USDC over x402

testing on mainnet, launch in Q3

Where h402 sits: the agent pays by itself, and it gets a verified pick instead of a list.

the agent gets
a verified pick

the agent gets
a list



How the recommended provider is chosen: we buy every route first, then keep re-scoring it on live calls.

01

Buy it

Nothing is listed until we have paid for it ourselves.

02

Measure it

Success rate, latency, price, from real paid calls.

03

Rank it

Providers on the same task, scored against each other.

04

Pin one

The agent gets an answer, not a menu.

every later call feeds the next score

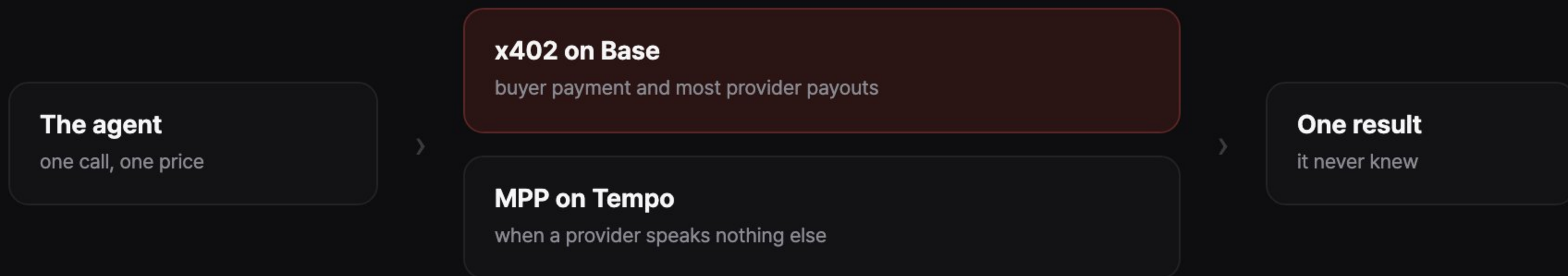
a listing

is a claim the seller makes about itself.

a settled payment

is a fact. A list can be copied in a week. A year of paid calls cannot.

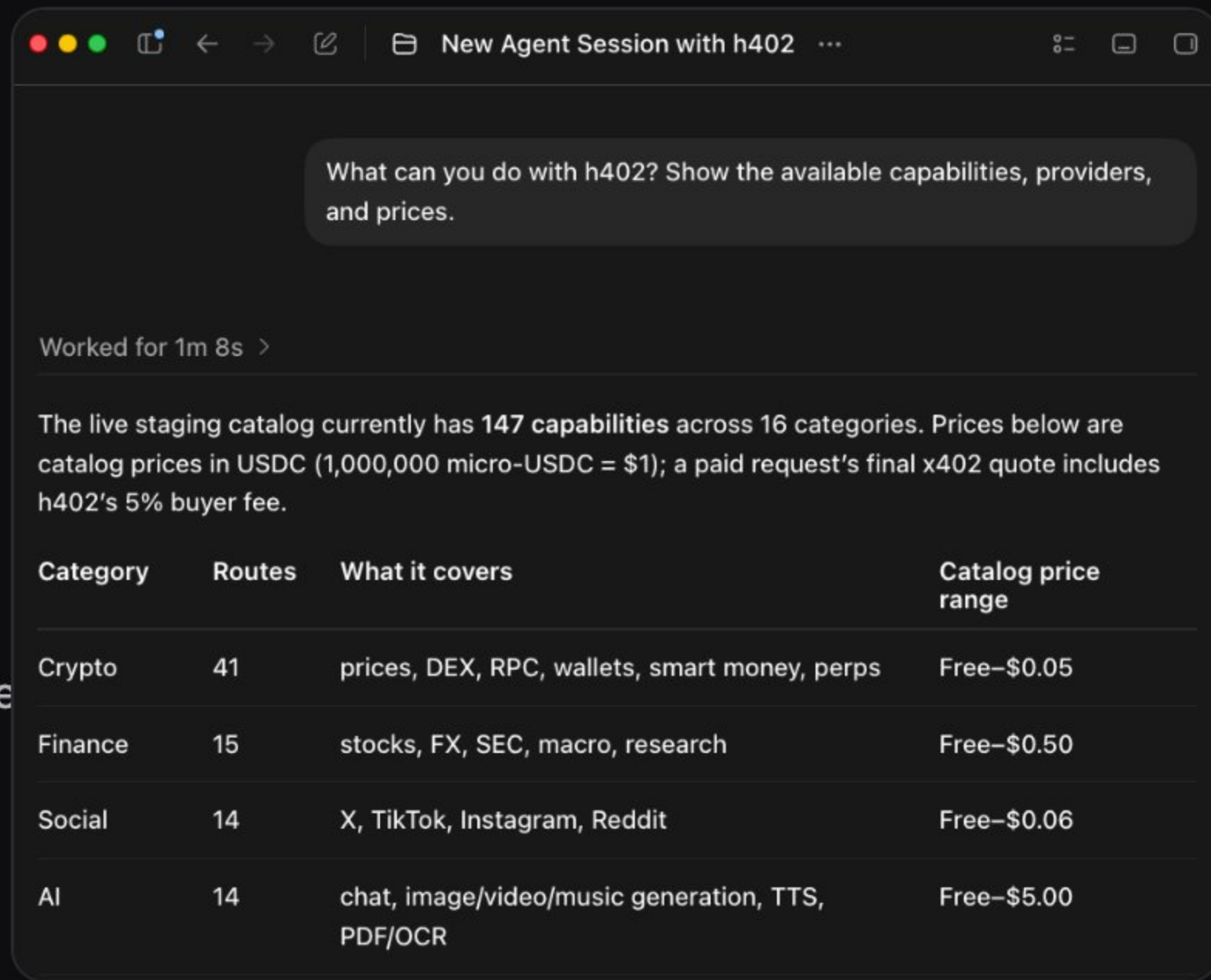
h402 already settles over two rails, x402 on Base and MPP on Tempo, and the agent still sees one call.



Which standard wins is not the agent's problem. A browser does not ask you to pick a TLS version.

A fresh session mounts h402 and pays for **real data**.

Nothing installed. Watch what it decides to buy, and what it shows before it spends.



What can you do with h402? Show the available capabilities, providers, and prices.

Worked for 1m 8s >

The live staging catalog currently has **147 capabilities** across 16 categories. Prices below are catalog prices in USDC (1,000,000 micro-USDC = \$1); a paid request's final x402 quote includes h402's 5% buyer fee.

Category	Routes	What it covers	Catalog price range
Crypto	41	prices, DEX, RPC, wallets, smart money, perps	Free-\$0.05
Finance	15	stocks, FX, SEC, macro, research	Free-\$0.50
Social	14	X, TikTok, Instagram, Reddit	Free-\$0.06
AI	14	chat, image/video/music generation, TTS, PDF/OCR	Free-\$5.00

Three things to take home, depending on what you build.

Building agents?

Your next design problem is a budget and a spend cap, not a prompt. Nobody has good defaults yet.

Selling an API?

Agents are customers who cannot sign up for anything. A middleware and a day is the whole lift.

Picking a protocol?

Do not. They are not competing for the same money. Sit behind an abstraction and let the price decide.